

The Creative Brief

Sheets for Success



Key Insight

Home goods such as bedding are often chosen because of their design rather than functionality. These aesthetic based products are rarely marketed to non-white Gen Z men because of the blue and grey corner that gender roles have wedged them into. This young generation is collectively navigating defining events such as high school, college, and living post graduation. In these uncertain times, *Martha Stewart* bedding provides non-white Gen Z men with dignified sheet options that convey a mature aesthetic while instilling comfort, confidence, and dependability.

Advertising Problem

Martha Stewart is an icon amongst women, however; the majority of non-white young Gen Z men have never heard of her. For *Martha Stewart* products, her name provides trust and reliability but this strategy is ineffective for our target audience. How can Martha Stewart's bedsheets stand out from competition without relying on her celebrity status to boost the appeal?

Advertising Objective

Martha Stewart bedding aims to show men that caring about the aesthetic of their room is not inherently feminine. For non-white Gen Z men, choosing the right bedding should be more than picking a neutral color. Intentionally selecting nice sheets is a sign that the non-white Gen Z man cares about his hygiene, sleep quality, and style. Prioritizing these factors will lead to success in school and relationships. *Martha Stewart* bedding provides non-white Gen Z men with sheet options that are an elevated version of a typical male aesthetic. Non-white Gen Z males will feel proud to choose Martha Stewart sheets because they can successfully enhance their sleep through an independent choice and receiving satisfying validation from others.

Competitors

Tommy Hilfiger: Founded in 1985, *Tommy Hilfiger* is a global fashion brand that Hilfiger himself has described as "affordable luxury." The brand targets young adults with a "timeless" and "preppy" aesthetic. According to YouGov data, *Tommy Hilfiger* currently ranks 32nd in the list of most popular clothing brands. The company's clothing and household items can be found in department stores such as Target, Macy's, Kohl's, and Walmart.

Nautica: Since 1983, *Nautica* has strived to bring classic, "nautical-inspired" wear to an audience all over the globe. Now, *Nautica* is a lifestyle brand, not only offering quality clothing, but bedding and fragrances as well. Like *Martha Stewart* and *Tommy Hilfiger*, *Nautica's* pricing remains in the 100 to 300 dollar range, while consistently being on sale. *Nautica's* main color scheme consists majorly of blues and whites, keeping to a predominantly male appearance. Like its competitors, it can also be found at department stores like Macy's, Walmart, and Dillard's.

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Target Audience

In recent years, male enrollment in college has been dropping. However, non-white Gen Z males are more likely than white Gen Z males to view higher education as a priority. (*Fast Company*). As groups that still earn less, non-white Gen Z males view college as a way towards a better future. While in college, students are likely to move into a dorm. Many will move to off campus housing as well. These non-white Gen Z men have multiple opportunities to select bedding that will define their personal style for the next formative stage of their lives.

Consumer Benefit

Martha Stewart bedding is making a promise to Gen Z non-white males that these sheets are their best option. *Martha Stewart* bedding is also promising that the sheets will bring them success in multiple aspects of their life. Results from good sleep and an aesthetic bedroom will bring success to school and relationships.

Support

According to the *YPulse* "Shopping for the Home Report," when asked what they planned to buy for their future homes, one of the highly ranked priorities for Gen Z (ages 13-23) was bed and bath, sitting at 31% behind two others (*Friedrick, FutureToday*). Non-white Gen Z males know that bedding is an important part of their new home, but they may not know the traits of quality bedding. With the advertisements, the important aspects of what makes these sheets stand out will be highlighted to differentiate *Martha Stewart* bedding from other companies.

Creative Direction

The creative direction taken is to highlight the success that will come when one uses *Martha Stewart* bedding. By emphasizing "success in relationships" and "success in school," this creates a new outlook on bedding that non-white Gen Z males may not already have. The look of the ads will merge the simplistic, clean look of the *Martha Stewart* website with a realistic view of the modern non-white Gen Z male's room. This will lead the viewer to envision themselves using this bedding because of they will relate to the realistic visuals. To cater to a non-white male audience, representation in the ads will be the main strategy.

Media Imperative

Through hashtags, the TikToks will show up on non-white Gen Z males algorithms. The poster will be at a bus stop on a college campus to capture the attention of college aged non-white Gen Z males who live in a dorm or apartment. The campaign will have an uplifting tone to encourage the consumer that this bedding will make life "successful."

Persona

Trey Smith is a 20 year old college sophomore planning out his first apartment. Being from Atlanta, Georgia and upper-middle class, he has never had to think much about his bedding or room essentials until now since he is going to school at JMU. His mother is very involved, so she typically steps in when it comes to giving him room necessities, like sheets. Trey cares about doing well while away from his parents, and wants to make it known that he can survive by himself. He prioritizes his school work, but like his peers, is out there looking for a future relationship at the same time. Trey is a friendly guy who enjoys being with friends and likes to go downtown at night. With this busy lifestyle, he does not have the time nor the care to research the best bedding. When Trey was passively scrolling on his phone, he saw a TikTok about the *Martha Stewart* bedding and it immediately caught his eye. He is looking for something accessible and fairly priced. He wants something neutral, soft, and ultimately, comfortable. At the same time, though, he wants to be different and better than the rest. What he does not want is bedding that will make him question if it is worth his money or not, mostly because he does not feel like putting in effort just to find sheets.

